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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP
COLLEGES OF EDUCATION
END OF SEMESTER ONE EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 300, 2024/2025
B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: UGTE 301
COURSE TITLE: TEACHING READING AND WRITING FOR UPPER PRIMARY

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.

Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

[25 Marks]

Answer **all** the questions in this section.

1. Which of the following options is a key principle in understanding the relationship between reading and writing?
   A. Only reading influences writing
   B. Reading and writing are independent skills
   C. They are reciprocal processes
   D. Writing precedes reading development

2. Which of the following options should be prioritised when designing an integrated reading-writing assessment?
   A. Authentic contexts and purposes
   B. Isolated skill measurement
   C. Standardized testing formats
   D. Timed writing exercises

3. In the context of writing development, what is the primary purpose of modelled writing?
   A. Children write independently without teacher support
   B. Students and teacher compose text together
   C. Teacher demonstrates the writing process explicitly
   D. Two students collaborate on writing tasks

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4. Which of the following characteristics of the EDRA diagnostic assessment tool makes it particularly valuable?
   A. Automated scoring system
   B. Detailed individual skill analysis
   C. Limited time requirement
   D. Simplified administration process

5. What distinguishes skimming from other types of reading?
   A. Detailed analysis of text
   B. Focus on specific information
   C. Quick overview of main ideas
   D. Word-by-word reading

6. Which of the following approaches is <u>most</u> effective when assessing reading comprehension?
   A. Multiple assessment methods combined
   B. Only literal comprehension questions
   C. Purely quantitative measures
   D. Single standardized test

7. Which of the following points is a potential challenge teachers might encounter when implementing the T-Master assessment?
   A. Excessive time requirements for individual assessment
   B. Limited availability of standardized materials
   C. Need for specialized technology
   D. Scoring complexity and subjectivity

8. What is the role of vocabulary development in reading comprehension?
   A. It affects only writing skills
   B. It is not essential for understanding
   C. It only matters in advanced texts
   D. It supports text understanding

9. Which approach to teaching reading emphasises the importance of learning letter-sound relationships and decoding skills?
   A. Balanced literacy approach
   B. Language experience approach
   C. Phonics approach
   D. Whole language approach

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10. What technological tool would be most effective for creating interactive phonics exercises?
    A. Digital storytelling software
    B. Email communication platforms
    C. Interactive whiteboard applications
    D. Word processing programs

11. Which reading problem is characterized by difficulty in connecting written symbols with their corresponding sounds?
    A. Comprehension deficit
    B. Fluency issues
    C. Lack of word decoding
    D. Vocabulary limitations

12. Which of the following writing problems is characterised by difficulties with fine motor skills and handwriting?
    A. Dysgraphia
    B. Dyslexia
    C. Dyspraxia
    D. Expressive language disorder

13. How does the schema theory influence reading comprehension?
    A. By focusing on letter recognition
    B. By highlighting phonemic awareness
    C. By organizing knowledge structures
    D. By teaching vocabulary directly

14. Which reading remediation strategy is most effective for improving fluency?
    A. Dictionary use
    B. Phonics drills
    C. Repeated oral reading
    D. Vocabulary flashcards

15. What is a key benefit of shared writing in classroom instruction?
    A. Develops independent writing skills
    B. Demonstrates proper handwriting technique
    C. Promotes collaborative learning
    D. Supports individual creativity

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16. What is the main purpose of reading aloud to students?
    A. Assess reading speed
    B. Model fluent reading
    C. Practice pronunciation
    D. Test comprehension

17. What is the primary advantage of silent reading in developing reading skills?
    A. Builds comprehension and reading speed
    B. Improves oral pronunciation
    C. Promotes social interaction
    D. Teaches proper intonation

18. Which of the following Teaching Learning Materials (TLMs) is most effective for early writing instruction?
    A. Digital tablets
    B. Lined paper with spacing guides
    C. Plain white paper
    D. Whiteboards

19. Which component of reading primarily focuses on speed and accuracy?
    A. Comprehension
    B. Fluency
    C. Phonemic awareness
    D. Vocabulary

20. Which of the following theories emphasises the role of background knowledge and prior experiences in understanding texts?
    A. Behaviorist theory
    B. Linear model theory
    C. Psycholinguistic theory
    D. Schema theory

21. What is the primary distinction between phonological awareness and phonemic awareness?
    A. Phonemic awareness deals with individual sounds, while phonological awareness includes larger units.
    B. Phonological awareness deals with writing, while phonemic awareness deals with reading.
    C. They are identical concepts with different names.
    D. They have no relationship to reading development.

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22. In the context of reading development, the "confirmation" stage is characterised by _____.
    A. First exposure to text
    B. Independent analysis of complex texts
    C. Reading familiar content to reinforce skills
    D. Writing complete narratives

23. Which model of reading suggests that reading is a purely bottom-up process?
    A. Cognitive model
    B. Interactive model
    C. Linear model
    D. Psycholinguistic model

24. Which of the following cognitive processes is most essential in early writing development?
    A. Abstract thinking
    B. Memory retrieval
    C. Pattern recognition
    D. Visual processing

25. Which aspect of writing development typically emerges last?
    A. Basic sentence structure
    B. Phonemic awareness
    C. Simple word writing
    D. Writing expressive texts

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SECTION B

[75 Marks]

Answer any **three** questions in this section.

1. a) Identify five (5) common problems teachers face in assessing reading and writing. [5 Marks]

   b) Discuss practical ways of solving any four (4) of these challenges in low-resource settings. [20 Marks]

2. a) List five (5) common misconceptions about reading, writing, and literacy development. [5 Marks]

   b) Discuss how any three (3) of these misconceptions affect classroom practices and suggest three (3) ways teachers can address them. [20 Marks]

3. a) Mention three (3) major approaches to teaching reading and writing. [3 Marks]

   b) Discuss the three (3) benefits and three (3) limitations of each approach. [22 Marks]

4. a) Discuss the major literacy problems that children face, with reference to Dysgraphia, Dyslexia, Expressive Language Disorder, and Dyspraxia. [16 Marks]

   b) Examine one (1) way by which each of these problems impact classroom learning. [9 Marks]

5. a) List the stages of reading and writing (literacy) development in children. [5 Marks]

   b) Discuss two (2) ways by which teachers can support learners at each of the different stages of literacy development. [20 Marks]